

Prototype Brief

One page, filled in before you build and after you test. Page two is the same page worked through on a real example.

PART 1 · THE BUILD BRIEF

Lesson 4.3 · write this before you open the tool

Four layers. Skip one and you get a landing page with fake testimonials.

1. Who + the job

one user, one job, in their words

2. One screen, one flow

two screens max, name the path

3. Fake data, specified

how many rows, how messy

4. The fence

what it must NOT build

PART 2 · THE TEST

Lesson 4.5 · all three before anybody sees it

Riskiest assumption

fatal AND unevicenced

The one question

one sentence

The one flow

three steps, no branches

What I faked

the expensive part, hardcoded

Success signal

a number, decided NOW

What would kill it

if I cannot answer, do not run the test

PART 3 · BEFORE YOU SHARE

Lesson 4.6 · sixty seconds

- ☐ Nothing real in it. No customer name, email, export, ticket, or screenshot with a live account.
- ☐ I know who can open this link, and I am content for it to travel.
- ☐ Nothing on screen reads as a commitment. No date, price, logo, or "coming soon".
- ☐ The disclaimer is on the screen, not just in my message.

PART 4 · SESSION LOG

same day, one line each, against the assumption

WHO	WHAT THEY DID	WHERE THEY STOPPED	WHAT IT SAYS

PASSED

hit the number

FAILED

missed it, and that is a result

WRONG TEST

I asked the wrong question

PART 5 · THE SHARE CARD

Lesson 4.7 · attach this to the link, every time

The question

The one flow

The disclaimer

Prototype. Invented data. Not a product. Nothing here is committed.

What happened

What I am asking for

a decision, not applause

Prototype Brief — worked

The same sheet, filled in for the team-scheduling prototype used throughout Module 4.

PART 1 · THE BUILD BRIEF

worked example

1. Who + the job	A team lead who has to find a 30-minute slot for five people this week without starting a chain of eleven emails.
2. One screen, one flow	Two screens. The team plus one suggested slot; a confirmation after they send it. Path: open, see the suggestion, send, confirmed.
3. Fake data, specified	8 invented teammates with realistic names and job titles. 3 weeks of invented calendar entries with a plausible amount of clutter. All data invented.
4. The fence	Do NOT build: a login, settings, an admin panel, payments, a landing page, a dark mode toggle.

PART 2 · THE TEST

worked example

Riskiest assumption	Four things must be true: they connect a calendar, they trust an automatic suggestion, the suggestion is good, and this beats messaging the group. Trust is the fatal, unevicenced one. The integration is a solved engineering problem.
The one question	Will a team lead trust a suggested slot enough to send it without editing it first?
The one flow	Open → see the suggestion → send.
What I faked	The suggestion itself. One hardcoded slot, invented calendars, and a send button that only says "sent". The algorithm is not the risk.
Success signal	4 of 6 send it without editing. Written down before session one.
What would kill it	If most people open the time picker before sending, they do not trust the suggestion, and the whole idea is a slower calendar.

PART 4 · SESSION LOG

worked example · what a real round looks like

WHO	WHAT THEY DID	WHERE THEY STOPPED	WHAT IT SAYS
Lead A	Sent it, no edit, 11 sec	—	Trusted it
Lead B	Opened the picker first, then sent the suggestion anyway	Hovered the time for ~6 sec	Checked, then trusted
Lead C	Edited the slot before sending	Looked for who was busy	Wants the reason, not the answer
Lead D	Said "looks great", never found send	Scanned bottom right	Said yes, did no
Lead E	Sent it, no edit	—	Trusted it
Lead F	Sent it, no edit, then asked if it emails them	—	Trusted it

PASSED

4 of 6 sent unedited

FAILED

WRONG TEST

Note what the number does **not** settle. Lead C wants to see *why* that slot, and Lead D never found the send button at all. The verdict is "trust holds", and the next prototype tests the reason line. That is a finding, not a lap of honour.

PART 5 · THE SHARE CARD

worked example

The question	Will a team lead trust a suggested slot enough to send it without editing?
The one flow	Open → see the suggestion → send. Nothing else works.
The disclaimer	Prototype. Invented data. Not a product. Nothing here is committed.
What happened	6 team leads, 20 minutes each. 4 sent it unedited. Target was 4 of 6.
What I am asking for	Twenty minutes at Thursday's roadmap review to decide whether this gets a discovery spike next quarter. Not a build commitment.